



40 LEAVES

ANIMALS

parrot

toucan

crownstar
eXpression®

sloth

texture

leopard

snake

Name : Chukwuka

Subject : R.M.

Class : _____ Date : _____

School : _____

leaf

* Brentano: Mental acts, perception as a form of
mental act, Themes in Brentano's philosophy
~~Perception~~

1. Discuss ontological and epistemological irrationalism.

2. Discuss the basic tenets of realism.

3. With particular attention to the four domains of spirit, comment on Croce's philosophy of spirit.

4. The Hegelian Absolute develops from imperfect conception through art and religion to a perfect conception as spirit and pure thought

- What does the word "Absolute" represent for Hegel.

- Explain Hegelian Method in the study (understanding) of the Absolute.

5 Existentialism and Kierkegaard's stages of Actualization.

Outline.

- Introduction
- Background of his philosophy.
- ~~Distinction between mental and physical phenomena~~
- Mental Acts.
- ~~Core~~ Themes of Brentano's Philosophy.
- Evaluation & Conclusion.

Introduction.

Franz Brentano (1838 - 1917) was a German philosopher. He studied mathematics, poetry, philosophy and theology. He was influenced by British empiricists such as John Locke. He is best known for his influential work on the nature of consciousness and intentionality. His major work was "Psychology from an empirical standpoint" (1874).

Brentano's philosophy bridged the gap between empirical science and philosophical inquiry, setting the stage for the development of phenomenology, existentialism and analytic philosophy. His focus on the distinction between mental and physical

Phenomena and the concept of intentionality remains central to his philosophical legacy.

Background of his philosophy

Brentano's philosophical adventure began as a reaction against German Idealism which defended the primacy of the mind over matter. However, he did not argue with the traditional way of doing philosophy but advocated that philosophy should adopt the rigorous method of natural science, which incorporates experimentation and demonstration.

He advocated also for philosophical psychology, which aims to study psychology with these methods, owing to the fact that his belief in philosophy should attend to the experiences of the individual person.

Brentano also introduced intentionality in philosophy, which posits that our mental states are not without content. For him, our thoughts are directional, which means they are directed to something. The mind has a content through which it derives the knowledge of an object.

Distinction between mental phenomena and physical phenomena.

To show the ~~work~~ operations of the mind

MENTAL ACTS

Mental acts according to Brentano are ^{activities} ~~sets of rules~~ of the mind that involve consciousness or awareness. They are processes through which a subject experiences or engages with something mentally.

According to Brentano, every mental act has an object towards which it is directed to. These objects which are immanent products of the mental state could have material or immaterial existence. He posits that there are some objects that exist mentally and have no real existence. For instance, one may be thinking of a walking stone or a flying horse.

Mental objects are products of mental acts, but they cannot be re-duplicated into reality. They are what Brentano referred to as intentional inexistence.

THEMES

Distinction between Mental acts and physical phenomena.

Brentano argued that knowledge is impressed on the mind. Hence one has to understand the methods of the mind to gain knowledge. He aimed at showing the workings of the mind in its claim to knowledge; as such he clearly outlined the distinguishing factors between the mental acts and physical phenomena. They are.

1. Mental phenomena are the exclusive object of inner perception.
2. Objects of inner perception always appear as a unity.
3. The objects of internal perception are always intentionally directed towards objects.

THEMES IN BRENTANO'S PHILOSOPHY.

There are basically three foremost themes in Brentano's philosophy. These themes include.

1. Perception
2. Judgment

3. Intentionality.

PERCEPTION.

Perception refers to the way sensory information is organized, interpreted and consciously experienced. Once there is there perception, there is impressions and impression evokes atoms of sensibility. Perception is therefore the ability to become aware of something through the sense.

Brentano, made a distinction between two types of perception; internal perception and external perception. Internal perception deals with mental knowledge while the external perception hinges on external knowledge. Brentano argues that inner perception is more real and dependent since it accounts for the mental activities of the individual more appropriately unlike the external perception which is prone to error.

However Brentano noted that this error of the external perception is referred to as misperception, as such we cannot talk about adequate knowledge from external perceptions.

JUDGMENT

Judgement is a fundamental mental act distinct from mere presentation or perception. Brentano distinguishes presentation and judgment, for him presentation is bringing something before the mind, while judgement involves affirming or denying the existence of the object presented. It is the negating or affirming of the impressions we have about something.

He also argued that judgement involves activity where one either affirms or denies the existence or non-existence of the object presented.

INTENTIONALITY

Intentionality is the aboutness of the something. It is the capacity of the mind to stand for and represent something.

According to Brentano, intentionality points to the fact that every mental act must have a corresponding object it tends to. Hence however these objects do not need to exist in reality, what

matters is the directedness of the mind toward an object.

He used the term intentional inexistence to describe the way objects of thought exist in the mind. Hence an intentional object is inexistent means that it exists within the mental acts as its object.

EVOLUTION AND CONCLUSION.

Impact of Existentialism on contemporary thought

Existentialism

Introduction

Meaning of ~~Introduce~~ Existentialism

Background of Existentialism

Basic tenets of Existentialism

Proponents of Existentialism

Evaluation & Conclusion

INTRODUCTION

Meaning of Existentialism.

Existentialism is a philosophical approach or movement that emphasizes the existence of the human person as a free and responsible person. It is a term used to describe position of philosophers who are interested in considering the human person from the concrete nature of his human existence and social structures. It explores the nature of human existence, focusing on the subjective experience of being and the inherent challenges of finding meaning and purpose in life.

Background of Existentialism.

Existentialism emerged in ^{20th} ~~19th~~ Century as a criticism to the social, traditional and intellectual landscape of the time. It arose majorly after the world wars when human dignity lost its relevance.

Existentialism also arose as an opposition to the idealists who summarized the human person by denying him of hope and confidence to tackle despair and depression.

The term existentialism was coined by a french philosopher 'Gabriel Marcel, who was one of the major proponent of this movement. Also, Other proponents include, Soren Kierkegaard who emphasized on the subjectivity of truth, leap of faith, personal choice and freedom. Also, Nietzsche, Martin Heidegger and Jean Paul Sartre are among the philosophers in this movement.

It is ^{to note} important that existentialism emphasizes human actions like freedom, responsibilities, decisions and human person.

Basic Tenets of Existentialism.

The basic tenets of existentialism include.

1. Philosophy as a way of life.

This entails that the various postulations and dictates in philosophy is not limited to classroom studies, instead it is a reflection of the way of life. Hence, philosophy concerns itself with real life situations and how we can adapt in our environment.

Hence, philosophy should not just be a discipline to be studied without having any influence on the

way of life of individuals in the society. As such philosophy is applicable to real life situations.

2. Situatedness: This refers to the circumstances or contextualization of a concept. For Existentialist, you cannot define man outside his context, because if you remove him from his situated environment, you would be prone to making a biased judgement. His situatedness helps to dictate his existence.

3. Inter Subjectivity: Existentialist holds that man is the subject of his existence, he is the subject of his existence as well as other human beings. However, man as his existence co-exists with other subjects, thus in expressing his subjectivity, he should recognize that of others in the society.

4. Freedom: Freedom is the absence of restriction or coercion on an object. Existentialist belief in freedom with responsibility. Man for them is free, however in his freedom, some unavoidable factivities limit his freedom. Nevertheless, his

- Irrationality & Absurdity.

freedom enables him to choose what he would make of himself.

5. **Anxiety and Authenticity:** Existentialist opine that man is faced with several events and situations that halt his happiness and propagate depression, leading to anxiety. For them, anxiety is a stepping stone to authenticity, since man becomes authentic by being able to face this anxiety and depressions on life. By facing it, man develops his emotions and becomes prepared to face fear.

PROONENTS OF EXISTENTIALISM.

1. **Soren Kierkegaard:** He is regarded as the father of existentialism. Posited that there is no objectivity in existence as such truth is subjective.
2. **Martin Heidegger:** He philosophized on the meaning of being- Dasein and the modes of existence (Authenticity and inauthenticity).
3. **Friedrich Nietzsche:** He developed ideals on will power.

Übermensch, the slave morality and master morality.

4. Jean-Paul Sartre - He philosophized on absolute freedom, and also established existentialism as humanism.

5. Karl Jaspers - He devoted on the study of the body mind and the soul of man and the preoccupation of death on the living.

Soren Kierkegaard.

Background of Kierkegaard.

Stages of Self Actualization.

Relationship between stages.

Evaluation & Conclusion.

Background of Kierkegaard.